

Let's get started

You've just wrapped up organizing your tasks for the week, and now your inbox is buzzing with emails. Amara has sent over an update on the client memo you've been working on, while Daniel has requested a review of the latest contract materials. There's also an email from HR regarding upcoming firm events, and you've received a follow-up from a pro bono client.

With several priorities competing for your attention, it's crucial to manage your inbox efficiently and maintain professionalism in your responses. Each email requires a clear, thoughtful reply, whether it's a quick acknowledgment or a more detailed update.

As you go through your emails, focus on providing timely updates, keeping your tone professional, and clearly outlining the next steps. Staying organized will help you manage your workload while meeting the expectations of your team.

Here are your task instructions

Now it's time to focus on responding to the important emails you've received. Follow the steps below to complete this task.

1. Review the emails: Go through the emails from key stakeholders below. Pay close attention to the nature of each request and its urgency.

2. Rank the emails by urgency: Prioritize the emails based on deadlines and the importance of each request. In the text box, start by drafting three emails in ranked order of importance, noting the subject line of each email to distinguish between responses. Consider which tasks need immediate attention and which can be addressed later.

3. Select the appropriate acknowledgment and response:

- Decide how to respond to each email. Some may require a detailed update, while others might only need a quick acknowledgment with a timeline for further action.
- Ensure that each response is professional and clear, setting expectations for the next steps or deadlines where applicable.

4. Craft a professional email response: For each of the emails, craft a professional response. Your email should:

- Include clear next steps and timelines for completing the task.
- Maintain an appropriate tone based on the recipient.
- Provide necessary updates and set expectations if deadlines need to be adjusted.

5. Submit your email responses: Once you've completed your email responses, submit them in the text input.

Here are some resources to help you

Email from Daniel (Partner)

Subject: Contract Review Request

Hi [Your Name],

I hope you're managing everything well. I need you to take a look at some additional contract materials for another client. The documents have just come through, and I'd like your initial thoughts by the end of the week. Please prioritize this after you've finished the memo for Amara.

Let me know if you anticipate any issues with timing or need assistance reviewing the materials.

Thanks,

Daniel Zhang

Partner

White & Case LLP

Email from HR

Subject: Timekeeping Records Due

Dear [Your Name],

This is a reminder to complete your timekeeping records for the current billing cycle by Friday. It's important that all associates log their hours in a timely manner to ensure accurate billing and compliance with firm policies.

If you have any questions or need assistance with the process, please don't hesitate to reach out.

Best regards,

Samantha Lee

HR Coordinator

White & Case LLP

Email from Amara (Senior Associate)

Subject: Status Update on Client Memo

Hi [Your Name],

I hope your work on the client memo is going well. I wanted to check in on your progress. Could you please send me a quick status update by the end of the day? I need to review the draft before we send it to the client tomorrow.

If you're facing any challenges or need clarification on any part of the task, feel free to let me know.

Looking forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,

Amara Patel

Senior Associate

White & Case LLP

1) Amara – Most Urgent

Subject: Re: Status Update on Client Memo – draft to you by 4:00 PM today

Hi Amara,

Quick update on the client memo:

- Research: complete and cited.
- Outline: finalized.
- Drafting: in progress on the Background and Analysis sections.

I will send you a full draft for your review by 4:00 PM today. After your comments, I'll turn an updated version first thing tomorrow morning and hold time to finalize before it goes to the client.

Please let me know if you want any emphasis changes (e.g., shorter executive summary, additional risk factors, or a recommended next-steps section).

Best,

Natascha

Next steps & timeline set: full draft 4:00 PM today; revisions tomorrow morning sent to client tomorrow.

2) Daniel – important, due end of week after memo)

Subject: Re: Contract Review Request – initial observations by Friday EOD

Hi Daniel,

Acknowledged. I'm prioritizing Amara's memo today and will begin reviewing the new contract materials immediately after I submit that draft.

Plan:

- Thursday: first pass (issues list + questions).
- Friday EOD: initial observations memo to you. If you prefer a redline instead of (or in addition to) and issues list, I can deliver that, please confirm your preference and any clauses you want special attention on (e.g., indemnity, limitation of liability, governing law, termination).

If anything shifts on your end, let me know so I can adjust sequencing.

Thanks,

Natascha

Next steps & timeline set: start after memo; issues list Thursday; initial observations Friday EOD; ask for preferred format and focus areas.

3) HR – administrative, due Friday

Subject: Re: Timekeeping Records Due – will submit by Thursday 3:00 PM

Dear Samantha,

Thank you for the reminder. I'm on track to complete and submit my timekeeping records by Thursday 3:00 PM, ahead of the Friday deadline. Please confirm if there are any updated billing codes for pro bono hours this cycle.

Best Regards,

Natascha

Next steps & timeline set: commit to Thursday 3:00 PM submission; ask for any code updates.

Example answer

Great work! Take a look at the example answer below to see how a professional would have attempted this task. Think about what you did well and how you can improve.

Task: Ranking the emails by priority

1. **Amara (Senior Associate):** Status update on the client memo due today, requires immediate attention.
2. **Daniel (Partner):** Contract review due at the end of the week, can be started after completing the memo.
3. **HR:** Timekeeping records due by Friday, administrative but important.

Email responses

Response to Amara (Senior Associate)

Subject: Status Update on Client Memo

Hi Amara,

I've completed the first draft of the client memo and will review it again before sending it to you by 4 p.m. today. Everything is on track for submission to the client tomorrow.

If you have any further feedback or changes after reviewing, please let me know, and I'll incorporate them right away.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Title]

White & Case LLP

Response to Daniel (Partner)

Subject: Re: Contract Review Request

Hi Daniel,

Thank you for sending over the contract materials. I'm currently finishing the client memo for Amara, and I will begin reviewing the contract materials immediately afterward. I expect to have my initial thoughts ready for you by Thursday afternoon.

Please let me know if this timeline works or if you'd like me to prioritize this differently.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Title]

White & Case LLP

Response to HR

Subject: Re: Timekeeping Records Due

Hi Samantha,

Thank you for the reminder. I'll make sure that my timekeeping records are completed by EOD on Friday.

If I encounter any issues, I'll reach out for assistance.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Title]

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